Many elements of the logic that drives India's engagement with Africa also apply to its larger approach to the Global South. There is a broad message of empathy and solidarity, but their expressions could be specific to the region or the country involved. It is visible in multilateral forums through platforms like the G-77, Non-Aligned Movement or the L.69 Group. With Small Island Developing States, this is evident in development projects, renewable energy spread and disaster resilience efforts.

At a time when much of the world has fallen back to a nationalism of an earlier era, enlightened Indian interests dictate that it puts even greater emphasis on internationalism. This is made easier by the fact that in Indian tradition, there has never been tension between the two. The presidency of the G20 provides just the right platform for this message to be driven home.

It is not just that important bilateral relations have started to get the attention that they long deserved. There are also more innovative group engagements at various levels. In the immediate and extended neighbourhood, we can see that in the East Asia Summit platforms, Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC), Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA), Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) and a Central Asia collective engagement. Beyond that, there are the IAFS, the Arab League dialogue, the SCO, the Pacific Islands Forum, the Caribbean Community (CARICOM) and Community of Latin American and Caribbean States (CELAC). Dealings with Europe have acquired a new intensity, not just with the EU but also with constituent members like the Nordic countries or the Slavkov format. The Commonwealth remains a long-standing commitment while the G20 has evolved into a growing priority. All of these are backed up by a plethora of ad hoc arrangements, like the BRICS, RIC, IBSA, Quad, I2U2 and multiple trilaterals. In addition, there are some key bilaterals and certain specific regions that will determine the smoothness of India's rise.

India has now entered a new phase of a multi-vector engagement that seeks to maximize outcomes and benefits. Its results have heightened its profile and changed its image. As a consequence, it is today perceived as a source of ideas, a champion of causes, a driver of initiatives and an advocate of consensus. No country or region is now seen as irrelevant to India's global calculus. Each of these examples highlights the importance of making friends and influencing people. This generous, intensive and